Picking Colonies

BEFORE YOU TOUCH A PLATE

Photograph the plates under blue-light transillumination and save the image. Once you have picked, this is the only record of what the colonies looked like.

PLAN

6 plates × 4 colonies = **24 wells**, across 1 × 24-well block.

Fill every well with **4 mL 2YT + carb** first.

PICK

1. Touch a sterile toothpick to a single well-isolated colony.
2. Drop the toothpick into the well. It stays in.
3. Repeat for 4 colonies from each plate.
4. Write the labels on an **airpore sheet** and cover the block with it.
5. Grow overnight in the multitron.

ORDER MATTERS

Pick in the order the samples are listed, left to right. The block's layout has to match the data-entry layout. If it does not, nothing errors — the results are just silently scrambled, and you find out weeks later.

WHICH COLONIES

– **Well-isolated only.** Never a small colony sitting beside a big one — that is a satellite, and it usually has no plasmid.
– A clone that reads at background *and* whose miniprep yields nothing was probably a satellite. Note it and exclude it.
– Write down why you picked each one ("very green, slow growing").

> **Do not pick by brightness.** If you choose the brightest and then correlate brightness against a prediction, the argument is circular. Pick naively. This is the mistake that cost Tlib2 its main result.

AFTERWARDS

1. Wrap the plates with parafilm.
2. Store them **upside-down in the fridge** — you may need to go back to them.
3. Upload the plate photo.